Document of ZJU-UIUC Institute

ZJU-UIUC Institute Doc. No. 2024-08

Issued by: Der-Horng Lee

Notice on Management Policy of Teaching Assistants at ZJU-UIUC Institute

1. General Information

To promote educational reform, effectively ensure the quality of course instruction, further strengthen the students' abilities in knowledge application, communication, teaching practice and management, and enhance the overall quality of student cultivation in ZJU-UIUC Institute (hereinafter referred to as "ZJUI"), this policy is formulated in the light of the actual circumstances at ZJUI and pursuant to MOE document (Opinions of the Ministry of Education on Accelerating the Construction of High-level Undergraduate Education and Comprehensive Improvement of Training Capacity on Talents [2018] No.2)," Management Measures of Teaching Assistant by Graduate Students at Zhejiang University " (ZJU Fa [2019] No. 39), and other relevant documents.

2. The Requirements and Responsibilities of Teaching Assistants (TA)

2.1 Teaching assistants are an important supporting force in the academic

teaching of ZJUI. The main purpose of setting up TA positions is to help students and to improve their learning effectiveness.

2.2 The responsibilities of TA include, but not limited to, attending classes, organizing seminars or discussion/tutorial sessions, classroom management or guidance, offering consultation in office hours, grading assignments or lab reports, participating in teaching preparation and assessment, developing/maintaining course website/platforms, collecting and analyzing course information, and other various supportive work.

2.3 TAs are required to fulfill their duties, to accept guidance and supervision from the course instructor, adhere to relevant work arrangements, and complete their responsibilities with high quality and quantity. For example, TAs should have punctual attendance to their duties, complete the marking of assignments or lab reports within one week after due dates, and provide feedback to students in a timely manner.

2.4 Individuals applying for a TA position must first obtain the consent of their supervisor or direct reporting officer, while the applicants should ensure that their TA duties will not adversely affect their normal academic and research performance.

2.5 TAs should maintain detailed records of their work, including weekly TA work logs (Appendix 1), mid-term work report (Appendix 2), and end-of-term work report (Appendix 3). These logs and reports are important materials for evaluating TAs.

3. The Requirements and Responsibilities of Course Instructors in Managing Teaching Assistant

3.1 The course instructor is responsible for managing TAs of his/her course, guiding, and training them in their daily work, supervising the quality of TA work and attitude of TAs, and promptly improving the TAs' work outcomes. For example, before the semester begins, the instructor should clearly inform the TAs of their job responsibilities and stipend amounts. During the semester, the instructor should provide timely guidance to the TAs, keep track of TA work performance that includes but is not limited to answering students' questions, monitoring student assignments, gathering student feedback after lecture and in tutorial sessions. Furthermore, instructors should complete mid-term and end-of-term assessments of their TAs on time.

3.2 The course instructor should make sure that TAs complete their work on time and with high quality. If it is found that a teaching assistant is unable to fulfill or complete the TA duties, the instructor should promptly provide guidance, urge TA to improve the work quality and attitude. If the teaching assistant's performance does not improve thereafter, the course instructor should promptly inform the relevant academic affairs office. Upon investigation by ZJUI, actions can be taken in accordance with the provisions in article 6.4.

4. Assignment of Teaching Assistant Position and Quota

4.1 In accordance with the needs of course, ZJUI provides high priority to assign TA positions in the core technical courses of undergraduate and graduate curriculum, especially the courses with large enrollment from several academic programs.

4.2 ZJUI sets up teaching assistant positions based on the nature of the course:

4.2.1. According to the following method, TA quota for each course is proposed:

i) For a course with 3~4 AUs, teaching weeks are ≥ 14 weeks in one semester, and enrollment ≥ 60 students, 1 TA quota is assigned in principle for the enrollment of every 60 students.

ii) For a course with large enrollment from multiple programs, in principle:

- 0.5 TA quota will be assigned to each parallel discussion/tutorial/lab session (those instructed by lab staffs are excluded).
- Every 60-students enrollment can have 0.5 quota for grading TA if necessary.

4.2.2 Academic Affairs Office for Undergraduates or Academic Affairs Office for Graduates would adjust TA quota of the courses according to the nature of the courses, such as the type of course, the number of teaching hours, the number of students enrolled, the demands for TA work, and the previous implementation, etc.

4.3 A TA position that meets all the following requirements is in principle

considered as a full-time TA quota.

4.3.1 TA fulfill the full duties for more than 14 weeks in one semester.

4.3.2 TA works at least 10 hours per week.

4.3.3 If there are any special circumstances, Academic Affairs Office for Undergraduates or Academic Affairs Office for Graduates will determine the workload.

4.3.4 TA receive scores as “Pass” or above in both TA evaluations of the semester.

5. Application, Appointment and Training of Teaching Assistants

5.1 TA positions are set up and appointed according to the following process:

5.1.1 The course instructor submits an application for TA position to the relevant academic affairs office at the end of the semester preceding to the one the course is offered. Based on the nature of the course and the actual needs, the instructor shall provide detailed information on the TA's responsibilities and workload requirements via Appendix 4. Academic Affairs Office for Undergraduates or Graduates will confirm the TA quota according to the nature of the course and the previous implementation.

5.1.2 According to the TA quota approved, the TA recruitment information will be posted to the academic affairs website of ZJUI. Candidates can only apply through this online platform for TA positions. The applications will be forwarded to course instructor for review. Once selected by instructor,

the application will then be forwarded to the relevant academic affairs offices for final approval. Applications that did not apply through the ZJUI website or were not approved by ZJUI, are considered invalid, and the candidate will not be recognized as a TA and will not receive TA allowances.

5.2 In principle, each candidate can only apply for one TA position. Priority is given to graduate students and above. Under any circumstances, undergraduate students should not be appointed as head TA.

5.2.1 Sophomore and above in full-time program, postgraduate students, postdoc research fellows or research associates can be appointed to TA positions of undergraduate courses.

5.2.2. In principle, TAs of postgraduate courses are selected from the current graduate students of ZJUI. In special circumstances, ZJU employees with master's degree and above or middle-level certificates can be appointed to TA position of postgraduate courses.

5.3 All of the candidates that apply for TA positions of ZJUI should meet the following criteria:

(1) Firm belief in and adherence to the core socialist values;

(2) Good conduct, physically and mentally healthy, with a sense of responsibility and initiative;

(3) Good academic performance, having previously taken the course for which they are applying to be a teaching assistant and received an A grade

or above, and possessing certain level of organizing, managing, and communication skills.

(4) Has good spoken and written English level and can handle professional communications related to the course contents in English.

(5) Has no record of violating school regulations or engaging in academic misconducts.

6. TA Evaluations

6.1 The relevant academic affairs offices of ZJUI are responsible for formulating the relevant requirements for TAs and the management for TA in accordance with the objectives of student cultivation, the characteristics of the major, and the actual situation of education programs at ZJUI. According to this, the office carries out the establishment of TA positions, the selection and appointment of TAs, and the disbursement of allowances. ZJUI should designate specific staff to be responsible for TA management matters and establish the records of TAs.

6.2 All of the TAs are required to participate in a training session for TAs that is organized by the relevant academic affairs offices at the beginning of each semester in order to acquire the basic knowledge and skills of TAs. Absent from the training session without a valid reason will be taken into account in the midterm evaluation of the TA.

6.3 The evaluations of TAs are organized twice per semester by the relevant academic affairs offices. The first is the midterm evaluation

(conducted in the seventh week of teaching), and the second is the end-of-term evaluation (conducted in the fourteenth week of teaching). The midterm evaluation is mainly conducted by the course instructor, and the evaluation outcome is either “Pass” or “Fail”. TA who receives a score of “Fail” in midterm evaluation will be handled according to the provisions of Article 6.4.

The end-of-term evaluation combines the evaluation outcome from the students and the course instructors. The evaluation scores from students and the instructor account for 50% of the total evaluation, respectively. The evaluation outcome of the TAs is categorized into three levels: Excellent, Pass, and Fail. The proportion of excellent TAs should not exceed 20%. Teaching assistant who receives a score of “Fail” in end-of-term evaluation, will be handled according to the provisions of Article 6.4.

6.4 For TAs who are unable to continue working or are unable to perform their duties, ZJUI may remove them from TA positions. For TAs who do not fulfill their job responsibilities, ZJUI may terminate their TA work at any time and stop their TA allowance. If a TA receives a “Fail” in any TA evaluations, ZJUI may terminate the TA work, remove him/her from TA position and stop the TA allowance immediately.

7. Allowance of Teaching Assistants

7.1 ZJUI provides an allowance to TAs in accordance with the actual workload. The allowance standard is 5000 yuan per semester (four months)

for one TA quota.

7.2 The allowance is paid to TAs once every 2 months. TAs must participate in the midterm and end-of-term evaluations organized by the relevant academic affairs offices and achieve a score as Pass or higher in order to receive the allowance. Within 4 working days after the completion of the TA evaluation, the relevant academic affairs office will submit the list of TAs who are eligible for the allowance and the amount of the allowance to the director of the relevant academic affairs offices for review, and then to ZJUI's General Administration office. The relevant academic affairs offices must ensure the accuracy and completeness of the list, and the list must be confirmed and signed by the director of the relevant academic affairs offices. The General Administration office of ZJUI must disburse the allowance to the students within one week after the office receives the list.

8. Appendix

This regulation shall come into force upon its official publication by ZJUI. The interpretation of this document lies to the Academic Affairs Office for Undergraduates, Academic Affairs Office for Graduates, and General Administration Office of ZJUI.

Appendix: 1. ZJU-UIUC Institute Weekly Work Log of Teaching Assistant

2. ZJU-UIUC Institute Teaching Assistant Midterm Evaluation

3. ZJU-UIUC Institute Teaching Assistant End-of-Term Evaluation

4. ZJU-UIUC Institute Application for Teaching Assistant Position (Course Instructor Use Only)

ZJU-UIUC Institute

April 29th, 2024

Appendix 1

ZJU-UIUC Institute Weekly Work Log of Teaching Assistant		
TA Name：		TA ZJU ID#：
Course Code：	Semester： 20 - 20 AY ○ SP ○FA	Instructor：
Week（ ）： ____Yr____M____D - ____Yr____M____D		
Work log：		total_____Hrs
Week（ ）： ____Yr____M____D - ____Yr____M____D		
Work log：		total_____Hrs
Week（ ）： ____Yr____M____D - ____Yr____M____D		
Work log：		total_____Hrs
Week（ ）： ____Yr____M____D - ____Yr____M____D		
Work log：		total_____Hrs
Week（ ）： ____Yr____M____D - ____Yr____M____D		
Work log：		total_____Hrs
Week（ ）： ____Yr____M____D - ____Yr____M____D		
Work log：		total_____Hrs
Week（ ）： ____Yr____M____D - ____Yr____M____D		
Work log：		total_____Hrs
Week（ ）： ____Yr____M____D - ____Yr____M____D		
Work log：		total_____Hrs

Appendix 2

ZJU-UIUC Institute Teaching Assistant Midterm Evaluation					
Course Code		TA Name		ZJU ID #	
Semester	20 - 20 AY ○ SP ○FA		Evaluation period	Week 1 to week 7	

Work Summary (filled by TA)：

During evaluation period, my TA hours is in total _____Hrs（weekly log is attached）。

I promise that the above information and the weekly log provided are true。

signature： Date：

For course instructor use only：

Evaluation: ○ PASS ○ Fail

Comments：

_____

_____

_____

Has the TA shown any of the following misconducts during work? (answer "YES" or "NO")：

- Fail to fulfill TA duty or refuse to follow your instructions _____
- Make major mistakes when he/she is doing TA work _____

Signature： Date：

For relevant academic affairs office use only:

According to the work summary, the allowance of the TA is _____.

Other information:

_____

Appendix 3

ZJU-UIUC Institute Teaching Assistant End-of-Term Evaluation					
Course Code		TA Name		ZJU ID #	
Semester	20 - 20 AY ○ SP ○FA		Evaluation period	week 8-week 14	

Work Summary (filled by TA)：

During evaluation period, my TA hours is in total _____Hrs（weekly log is attached）。

I promise that the above information and the weekly log provided are true。

Signature ：

Date：

For course instructor use only：

Evaluation score: _____/ 100

Comments：

_____

_____

_____

_____

Has the TA shown any of the following misconducts during work? (answer "YES" or "NO"：

- Fail to fulfill TA duty or refuse to follow your instructions _____
- Make major mistakes when he/she is doing TA work _____

Will you recommend the TA for Institute TA award? ○ Yes ○ NO

Signature：

Date：

For relevant academic affairs office use only:

The survey received the feedback from _____students out of _____enrollment. The overall score is _____/50.

Combined with the evaluation score from course instructor, TA evaluation score is _____/50.

The evaluation outcome of the TA: ○ Excellent ○ Pass ○ Fail

Appendix 4

ZJU-UIUC Institute Application For Teaching Assistant Position （Course Instructor Use Only）					
Course Instructor			Course Name & Code		
Semester & AY			Lecture Time		
Course AU		Teaching weeks	□7 week □14 weeks	Enrollment (expected)	
Work load and duties of TA position： Expected work load: _____hours/week The number of TA position: _____; The quota for each position: _____. Signature： _____ Date： _____					
Other information if applied:					
Institute Comments： ☐ Approve _____ quota in total □ NOT Approve Signature： _____ Date： _____					

Note:

1.If the course is a postgraduate course, please submit the form to graduate academic affairs office.

2.If the course is an undergraduate course, please submit the form to undergraduate academic affairs office.

3.If the course opens to both UG and PG students, please submit the form to both academic affairs offices.

4.If the enrollment has a huge discrepancy to expectation, both offices can readjust the quota assigned.